head was soiled and **tattered**; He knew that his father would come back with sacks full of silver and his mother with gifts from Allah. Then he would have more than Mahmood, Mohsin, Noorey and Sammi.

Hamid's Granny Ameena was sad. It was Eid and she did not have even a handful of grains. If only her son were there, it would have been a different kind of Eid! Hamid went to his grandmother and said, "Granny, I will be the first to get back. Don't worry!" Ameena was worried. Other boys were going out with their fathers. How could she let him go to the fair all by himself?

Hamid left with the other boys. Hamid was like one with wings on his feet. They ran on ahead of the elders and waited for them under a tree. They reached the **suburbs** of the town. On both sides of the road were big houses of the rich. In the gardens, mango and leechee trees were full of fruits. Then they came across the stores of the sweets - vendors. All decorated so **gaily**! Every store had sweets piled up in heaps like mountains.

GLOSSARY		
dazzling	–	extremely bright
tattered	–	torn
suburbs	–	outlying area
gaily	–	in bright colours

OFHTA

Choose the correct answers and fill in the blanks.

1. 'Finally the day had come'. Here **the day** refers to _____.

   a. Pongal
   b. Christmas
   c. Eid

2. With their treasure, the boys would buy _____ in Eidgah.

   a. pens and pencils
   b. toys and rubber balls
   c. chocolates and cakes

3. Hamid's friends are _____.

   a. Mahmood, Mohsin, Noorey and Sammi
   b. Raghul, Preethi, Sam and Mufeed
   c. Rani, Verghese, Sita and Zahir

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